



BRENDAN HOFFMAN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A Moment of Hope for Ukraine
Launching a midrange attack. Kyiv’s huge supply of drones has helped it disrupt Russian supply lines and troop rotations. Page A8.

Years of Buttering Up Trump Ahead of World Cup

By TARIQ PANJA and REBECCA R. RUIZ

For the past year, FIFA, the governing body of international soccer, has leased an office on the 17th floor of New York’s Trump Tower that has sat all but empty. The rent goes to President Trump’s family business, but soccer officials say the space sits largely idle.

Paying rent to the Trumps was the choice of Gianni Infantino, FIFA’s president, who has made being close to Mr. Trump a top priority. He has lavished the president with praise, trophies and a medal. He has made pilgrimages to Mar-a-Lago, the Trump Na-

A Charm Effort Offered Praise, Cozy Ties and a Peace Prize

tional Doral golf club and even the “Melania” documentary premiere.

Mr. Infantino has publicly boosted the president through impeachments and plummeting poll numbers.

It was all in service, Mr. Infantino’s supporters say, of ensuring that the World Cup, which begins Thursday, goes off without a hitch. Mr. Trump could disrupt the games in any number of ways. Mr.

Infantino, allies say, is handling a volatile president who responds to praise and gifts.

“He’s straightforward in terms of what you need to do to manage the relationship,” said Majed Al Sahib, a soccer official from Saudi Arabia who said that Mr. Infantino was being pragmatic.

FIFA officials are clear about what they want from the World Cup. They want a higher profile in the United States and more growth in the world’s biggest consumer market. They also want to shed the reputation for corruption and cartoonish excess that led to Justice Department prosecutions.

Mr. Infantino failed to woo the Biden administration, former gov-

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NEWS ANALYSIS

Hope and Fear With Platner

Democrats Gamble in High-Stakes Maine

By LISA LERER

Graham Platner’s primary victory in Maine sends Democrats barreling into one of this year’s most important Senate contests with a rush of insurgent energy but gnawing uncertainty about the withering Republican scrutiny to come.

His decisive victory offered a vivid display of the deep Democratic desire for a new generation of leaders, suggesting that many primary voters in Maine embraced his populist economic message and working-class appeal.

Yet in nominating Mr. Platner, Democrats are making an enormous bet in their quest to regain control of the Senate, staking their chances in a crucial race on an untested and scandal-plagued oysterman.

Maine is a linchpin of both parties’ midterm strategies. With Republicans holding 53 seats in the Senate, Democrats will have to defend all the seats they hold and flip four more to win control in November. For months, party leaders have believed their most likely path ran through North Carolina, Ohio, Alaska and especially Maine — the only state of the four that voted against President Trump in 2024.

But Mr. Platner’s controversy-filled ascent to the Democratic

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CALIFORNIA RACE Steve Hilton will face Xavier Becerra to become the next governor. PAGE A14



YARA NARDI/REUTERS

A Blessing or a Curse?
A papal visit didn’t stop Barcelona residents from debating about Gaudi’s grand basilica. Page A10.

A Killer, an Officer and a Good Samaritan: Echoes of 3 Deaths

By MIKE BAKER

ARVADA, Colo. — As he so often did, Ronald Troyke began his day swiping through YouTube, fixated on videos from the same genre: police officers caught doing something wrong.

Mr. Troyke, 59, watched the clips alone, surrounded by his sparse belongings — a folded paper about concealed firearms, greeting cards from a sister worried about his mental health, a tote bin that was labeled “gun stuff.” At 9:30 a.m. that morning in June 2021, he watched a last video about a police officer in Ohio who had driven over a man lying in the street. He could bear it no longer.

On the wall of his apartment bedroom in Arvada, Colo., he taped a handwritten message — some words scribbled in ALL CAPS, others underlined — raging about police corruption and a

Colorado Police Reflect 5 Years Later

lack of accountability. “The people have had enough,” he wrote.

He folded another note into his wallet that included a vow: “Today I will kill as many Arvada officers as I possibly can.”

Jumping into his Ford pickup,

which was stocked with a handgun, a semiautomatic shotgun, an AR-15-style rifle and a stack of high-capacity magazines, Mr. Troyke drove a mile to Olde Town Square. It was a gathering place for the community, home to a children’s spray park and, on weekends, a farmers’ market. Mr. Troyke also knew it was a place where police officers patrolled; he had confronted three of them

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Multiple U.S. Airstrikes In Iran as Trump Voices Frustration With Talks

Drawn-Out Conflict Is Driving Inflation Sites on Strait Hit in 2nd Day of Attacks

By LYDIA DePILLIS

Inflation accelerated for a third straight month in May as the stalemate in negotiations with Iran has kept energy prices high, adding to the burden on already strained consumers.

The Consumer Price Index rose 4.2 percent in May from a year earlier, the Bureau of Labor Statistics reported on Wednesday, a sharp rise from the 2.4 percent annual increase before the conflict started in February and the fastest pace since April 2023.

The increase has been driven almost entirely by energy prices, which are up 23.5 percent from this time a year ago. Americans have felt that effect most acutely while filling up their vehicles: A gallon of gasoline costs \$4.15 on average, according to AAA, up more than a dollar from a year ago.

Faster price gains have wiped out the pay increases Americans have received over the past year, on average. Adjusted for inflation, hourly earnings have fallen 0.7 percent over the past year and are exactly where they were when President Trump returned to office. Tax refunds that came in the spring have been spent, and reductions to the federal Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program are now cutting into food budgets.

“It’s quite a negative situation,” said Stephen Brown, chief North America economist for Capital Economics. “Low-income consumers don’t have a lot of room to maneuver at this point.”

That dynamic was visible across earnings reports at large retailers in recent weeks. Dollar General, the discount chain, told investors that its customers had been pulling back on food purchases and looking to shop closer to home because of high gas

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This article is by *Lara Jakes, Max Bearak, Jonathan Swan and Michael Levenson.*

American forces bombed Iran for the second straight night on Wednesday, hours after President Trump said that Iran was taking “too long to negotiate” a peace deal.

Iranian state news outlets reported explosions on two islands near the Strait of Hormuz, the hotly contested commercial waterway, as well as in the cities of Minab, Sirik and Bandar Abbas, near an airport and air base. They also said that air defenses had been activated in the capital, Tehran.

As Mr. Trump alternates between promising peace and threatening to return to full-scale war, neither has happened. But now the war that the United States and Israel launched in February looks as if it could be escalating, despite a cease-fire agreed to in April.

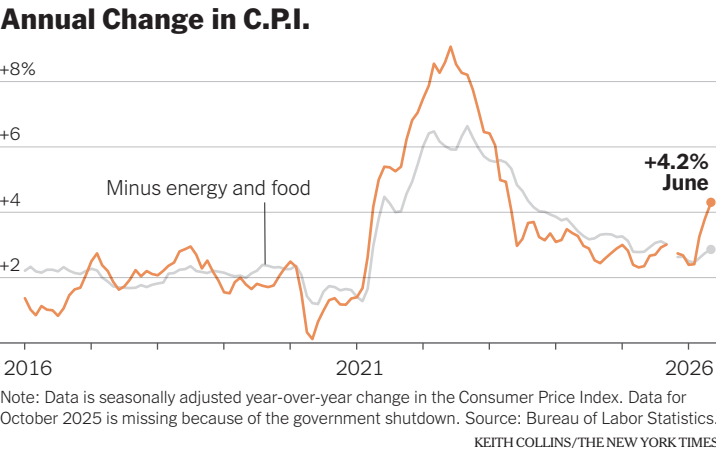
The U.S. attacks on Iran a day earlier were a direct response, Mr. Trump said, to the downing of an American attack helicopter near the Strait of Hormuz. The strikes on Wednesday — early Thursday morning in Tehran — appeared to have been launched because Mr. Trump was losing patience with Iran’s diplomatic posture. Weeks of indirect talks have failed to produce a diplomatic breakthrough.

“They’ve taken too long to negotiate a deal that would have been great for them, now they will have to pay the price!!!” the president wrote on social media, hours before the latest airstrikes.

U.S. Central Command said the strikes on Wednesday had been carried out on Mr. Trump’s orders and were a “response to Iran’s unwarranted and continued aggression.”

With no end to the turmoil in the

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Thousands of SpaceX Workers Near New Frontier: Millionaire

By KIRSTEN GRIND

SAN FRANCISCO — As Trevor Hise was preparing to graduate from college in 2011, his parents wanted him to take what they saw as a stable job at General Electric. But Mr. Hise had landed an internship at a start-up he loved. Against his parents’ advice, he stayed for a full-time job at that young company for the next 12 years.

The start-up was Elon Musk’s SpaceX.

Today, Mr. Hise has more than 100,000 SpaceX shares that he earned from his time working there. With the rocket maker expected to go public this week at \$135 a share, Mr. Hise’s SpaceX stock is likely worth at least \$13.5 million — a sum that has left him in disbelief.

“The magnitude of this has been ridiculous,” said Mr. Hise, 37, who worked as a SpaceX launch engineer and now considers himself semiretired.

SpaceX’s journey to the stock market has been defined by a series of superlatives. It is the biggest-ever initial public offering of the most dominant space company by the world’s richest man. And it is set to unleash generational wealth if its shares soar in its trading debut at the whopping valuation of \$1.77 trillion, five times the market capitalization of General Electric.

SpaceX’s I.P.O. is expected to make a lot of rich people even richer. First in the queue is Mr.

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THURSDAY STYLES D1-6

A Museum for the Boss
Bruce Springsteen, above with Patti Scialfa, opened up his Center for American Music, a cultural hub. PAGE D1

Fast and Fashionable
Diljeet Dosanjh Taylor, a coach at Brigham Young University, has helped turn it into a running powerhouse. PAGE D6

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Charges Over Hong Kong Fire
Seven people and two companies are accused of dozens of offenses, including manslaughter, in a blaze at an apartment complex that killed 168. PAGE A4

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Lawsuit Filed Over Statues
The mayor of Quincy, Mass., wants to install 10-foot statues of two Catholic saints at a new public building. PAGE A11

Trump Backs Intelligence Pick
The president stood by his decision to nominate Bill Pulte, a close political ally with no known experience. PAGE A15



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War Strains Dubai’s Mettle
In an emirate built on stability, dependence on trade and travel has become an economic vulnerability. PAGE B1

Debt Collectors Have Bills, Too
As more people fall behind, the workers calling them to collect often endure a torrent of verbal abuse. PAGE B1

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A Series Tests Fans’ Fingernails
Now tied at 2-2, the Stanley Cup finals between the Hurricanes and the Golden Knights have had goals, comebacks and emotional swings galore. PAGE B10

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Twain Scholar Who Cut Slur
Alan Gribben made it his mission to fix what he saw as flaws that kept schools from teaching the American author’s most famous works. PAGE B13

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In the Thick of the Action
M.I.A. discusses whether her legacy of incitement has posed difficulties, and how either side of the American political divide has treated her. PAGE C1

